

Academic Writing 101

Fall 2025

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Office: SOS 108

Office Hours: Wednesdays 10:00-13:00

14:00-16:00

Course Description:

ACWR 101 makes use of a content-based approach to initiate students into the conventions of academic language and discourse. The course supports students with written and verbal feedback sessions. While emphasis is placed on developing writing through a process-based approach, other linguistic and critical skills are also covered. Students are expected to improve their reading and writing abilities so that they can produce clear, linguistically accurate, and sophisticated discourse suitable for a variety of academic settings. Ultimately, students are expected to develop their independent, authoritative, individual academic “voice.”

In the ACWR 101 Course, students will:

- develop a process-based approach to academic writing;
- acquire a basic knowledge of and ability to use APA documentation, including in-text citations and a reference page;
- organize and express ideas in a manner appropriate to the audience and purpose;
- familiarise themselves with strategies for different kinds of writing;
- accurately employ the tools of paraphrase and quotation;
- present their writing in a format appropriate for formal academic writing that uses academic vocabulary and employs high standards of grammar, usage, and mechanics.

Course Theme: Identity in the digital world: Who are you really?

In this course, the students will do readings about constructing identity based on cultural, social, sexual, etc. influences in the digital age. We will tackle the relationship between the individual and the society, the impact of localism and universalism, migration, and more on forming our identities through ethical, psychological, and social perspectives. Some of the topics we will develop our arguments around include social versus real identity, anonymity and digital courage, avatars and online identity, digital nomadism, cancel culture, online activism, and deepfake.

Overall Course Requirements and Grading:

Essay 1	30 %
Essay 2	35 %
Participation	15 %
Homework and Class Tasks	20 %

Required Course Materials:

Course pack will be available at the copy center

You can find class related materials and homework submission links at:

<https://learn.hub.ku.edu.tr/>

Attendance & Participation:

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Minimum 70% attendance is mandatory. All students are expected to attend and participate in all lessons on the days and times announced in KUSIS. Based on YÖK policy, ACWR 101 attendance policy is as follows:

Attendance will be taken for 18 sessions. Minimum 70% attendance (13 sessions) is required to submit the final essay. Students can miss up to 30% of the class sessions (5 class sessions) without penalty.

Students who miss 6 or more with or without valid medical reports (approved by the KU Health Center) or official excuses (from the office of the Dean of Students) will not be eligible to submit the final essay.

Participation is defined as engagement or involvement in the class, i.e., coming to class prepared and with an annotated text, interacting with the instructor and classmates, asking and answering questions, taking notes, and completing all individual tasks and group activities including discussions, reading, writing, sharing, and fulfilling all course expectations.

Homework and Class Tasks:

Homework and class tasks are requirements of the ACWR 101 Course. Points will be awarded for completing homework assignments and class tasks, contributing to discussions, and uploading required tasks promptly. To earn your homework and class task points, you must access all required material, read the task instructions, and submit the task on the designated date. Quizzes will be worth x2 points. Official excuses and medical reports will not be accepted for homework and class task submissions. Non-submission, incomplete submissions, and/or late submissions of the abovementioned will negatively impact your homework and class task grade. Email submissions are not accepted. No exceptions. Abide by deadlines as the submission links will not allow late submissions, and you will not have an opportunity to make it up to a missed homework submission.

In-class writing assignments' completion may affect your participation grade.

Homework assignments (grade breakdown for 20%):

Paraphrasing assignment: 1 point

Formal Task 1: 2 points

Formal Task 2: 2 points

Discussion Board Assignments 1 X7 points

Academic integrity test: 2 points

Introduction paragraph: 1 point
Conclusion paragraph: 1 point
APA quiz: 2 points
Quiz 2: 2 points
Total 20 points (20% of your course grade)

Essay 1:

This is a three-hour, in-person writing assignment where students write a 700-900 words argumentative essay using sources previously read in class. The essay writing is “open book,” so students can bring the selected texts to the room. Students will be required to write an essay that has an introduction, a thesis statement, a minimum of three body paragraphs with topic sentences and citations from at least two different articles in each paragraph, a conclusion, and a reference page. Medical excuses submitted through the university are valid to qualify for a make-up midterm essay. The make-up essay will be administered as a common essay for all eligible ACWR 101 students at a date to be announced later and will be on a theme that might not be the same as an individual student’s course theme. There will not be a make-up for the make-up.

Essay 2:

Final Essay is a 800-1000 word argumentative essay that has an introduction, a thesis statement, a minimum of 3 body paragraphs engaging with prescribed sources through multiple citations, at least 2 citations in each paragraph, topic sentences, a conclusion, and a reference page. The essay is open book, so students can bring the selected texts to the room. Students who fail to have attended 70% of the class sessions with attendance requirement are not entitled to submit a final essay. Any essays submitted under this condition will not be taken into consideration and will not receive a grade. Medical excuses submitted through the university are valid to qualify for a make-up final essay. The make-up essay will be administered as a common essay for all eligible ACWR 101 students at a date to be announced later and will be on a theme that might not be the same as an individual student’s course theme. There will not be a make-up for the make-up. There will be no remedial essay.

There is no remedial exam offered in this course.

Student Assignment Agreement:

Please be aware of the Koç University Student Assignment Agreement for all homework assignments, class tasks, and essay submissions. When submitting your work online, you are agreeing to the following:

I hereby accept that only the below-listed sources are approved to be used for ACWR 101 assignments:

- (i) Coursebook (Readings)
- (ii) All material that is made available to students via LearnHub for this course, and
- (iii) Notes taken by me during lectures.

I have not used, accessed, or taken any unpermitted information from any other source. Hence, all effort belongs to me.

You MUST copy and paste the Student Assignment Agreement to your Final Essay Submission

The Use of AI Tools & Typing Assistants:

One of the main differences between most faculty specific courses and ACWR 101 is its emphasis on formulating, articulating, and questioning one's own thoughts rather than constantly absorbing information. As such, ACWR instructors expect a variety of forms of "engagement" from students. Students will read the assigned texts, join everyday conversation with their classmates, participate in class discussions with their questions and/or answers, listen to their classmates' opinions and argumentation, take active part in pair and group work, and drop by their instructor's office hours for talking about course topics. In addition to these, each student should be actively involved in their own learning. In a writing course, this involvement will require a constant process of drafting, i.e. brainstorming, outlining, writing, editing, deleting, writing again, taking feedback, and revising in both argumentative and sentence level. It is only through these steps that students can improve as writers. Therefore, the implementation of AI writing assistance to skip these steps will only hinder students' academic development. As a result, the use of artificial intelligence-based tools, such as ChatGpt; typing assistants, such as Grammarly and Quillbot; and translation tools, such as Google Translate and DeepL, is

prohibited for the good of our students. It is the students' responsibility to turn off these tools if they function as extensions or are integrated within their word processors or internet browsers.

ACWR instructors are quite adept at differentiating artificially generated language from a student's own writing. Similarly, Turnitin is efficient at detecting AI-powered writing (help). Therefore, the reasons behind how some of your writing might be detected as AI will not be accepted as excuses. If an assignment is not touched by an AI-tool, then Turnitin does not detect anything. This is tested and proven many times within our classes.

Academic Dishonesty:

Koç University's VPAA considers the following as Academic Dishonesty: cheating in a written task, providing help to another student for a task, attempting to cheat or providing help to another student, partially or completely plagiarizing homework, papers, or projects without properly acknowledging the source or making someone else write or edit one's homework, paper, or project.

Plagiarism is borrowing or using someone else's writing or ideas without giving written acknowledgment to the author. This includes copying from a fellow student's paper, from a published or unpublished text written by someone else, or from an internet site without properly citing the source. Collusion is getting unauthorized help from another person such as having someone else write/edit one's assignment or having someone else take an exam with false identification. For other types and definitions of Academic Dishonesty, please check VPAA's student code of conduct.

Please note that according to Koç University and YÖK policies, in case of academic dishonesty (see [Disciplinary By-Law Regarding Students of Institutions of Higher Education](#): Article 5, Article 7), the instructor should report the student to his/her Dean. In such cases, your instructor will initiate disciplinary action and your Dean will inform you of the process.

Grading Scale:

·	A+ = 100 – 97%	B+ = 86 – 83 %	C+ = 76 – 73 %	D+ = 66 – 64 %
·	A = 96 – 90%	B = 82 – 80 %	C = 72 – 70%	D = 63 – 60 %
·	A- = 89 – 87%	B- = 79 – 77%	C- = 69 – 67%	F = 59 – 0%

Grade Disputes:

Students should bear in mind that the instructor reads every assignment carefully and assigns a grade that accurately reflects the student's relative mastery of the assignment.

Students should respect the instructor's expertise in the subject matter and value their judgement.

If you do ask for a grade dispute you must follow the instructions given below. Please note that not all petitions are accepted.

Make an appointment with your instructor as soon as possible once the grade has been posted to discuss your concerns.

During your meeting, ask the instructor to explain how the assignment was graded in terms of Content, Organization, Language/Mechanics, or other grading criteria. Clarify with your instructor whether your grade was penalized due to late submission, failure to comply with certain instructions, failure to meet the goals for the assignment, or for any other reason. If you have difficulty understanding your instructor's explanation, ask for the explanation in written form. If you remain unsatisfied with your instructor's explanation of the grade, proceed to step 3.

Send a detailed petition via email to Murat AK in the CSSH Dean's Office – muak@ku.edu.tr

If you have concerns about multiple assignments, include a separate petition form for each assignment you request to be reassessed. You may NOT fill out a petition asking for all course assignments to be reviewed.

Keep in mind that your assignment grade and your final grade in the course may go up, down, or remain unchanged as a result of the reassessment process.

These petitions will only be accepted within seven days after the grade has been posted to discuss the grade(s) in question.

Koç Office of Learning and Teaching (KOLT) kolt@ku.edu.tr OR elarning@ku.edu.tr

The helpful KOLT team is always happy to provide training and/or assistance to you.

If you have computer/system problems during the semester, you should immediately contact:

Koç IT Remote Services through IT-Track-it it@ku.edu.tr

Please note: Contacting IT-Track-it should be your priority if any system or internet problem occurs when submitting assessments or graded tasks.